

Sweet Pepper: Case Study Plan (The Five Faces)

Target: Thematic / Modular Structure

The Hook (Results First)

TL;DR, high-fidelity visuals of the day/night modes, and the core 50/50 problem: 1 venue, 4 daily identities, 0 generic templates.

Face 1: The Visual System

Taming 12 years of chaotic artifacts.

- The strict 3-hue generative color rule.
- The typography logic (Molot for display, Golos for reading).
- Auditing your own accessibility claims (fixing contrast ratios and the "colour-blind safe" oversight).

Face 2: The Core UX Mechanic

The "Heat = Time" concept.

- How the hospitality "no-clock rule" birthed the spice slider.
- Why real usability testing forced a pivot from the slider control to the final 4-tile photo grid.

Face 3: Voice & Content Architecture

Words as the interface.

- The dynamic status lines ("lunch till 4 — no rush").

- Building the menu matrix.
- Treating the Russian/English layers as "register twins" rather than 1:1 translations.

Face 4: The Reality Build & Constraints

Shipping real software in a constrained environment.

- Dealing with Geopolitics: OFAC sanctions ruling out Webflow, forcing a self-hosted WordPress build.
- Managing Russian data laws and localizing the map/social experiences.
- Building a backend that the venue team can actually operate.

Face 5: The Details & Polish

The interaction vocabulary.

- The page loader toy (the slider's final home).
- The "bartender's ticket" UI.
- Using the browser as the final drawing board and logging decisions in `testing.md`.

Reflection

Systems outliving the launch.

- Systemizing beats redesigning.
- Loud color needs more rules, not fewer.
- Iterating the layout, not just the polish.